IPSS / AUA Symptom Index — BPH

men with lower urinary tract symptoms · over the past month

IPSS 0–35

QUESTIONS 1–6: HOW OFTEN OVER THE PAST MONTH?

Score	0	1	2	3	4	5
	Not at all	<1 in 5 times	< half the time	About half	> half the time	Almost always

SYMPTOMS (EACH 0–5)

Question	Score
1. Incomplete emptying — sensation of not emptying the bladder	0–5
2. Frequency — urinating again <2 hours after finishing	0–5
3. Intermittency — stopping and starting several times	0–5
4. Urgency — difficult to postpone urination	0–5
5. Weak stream	0–5
6. Straining to begin urination	0–5
7. Nocturia — times up at night to urinate (none = 0 … ≥5 = 5)	0–5
Total	**0–35**

QUALITY OF LIFE (SCORED SEPARATELY, 0–6)

0	1	2	3	4	5	6
Delighted	Pleased	Mostly satisfied	Mixed	Mostly dissatisfied	Unhappy	Terrible

INTERPRETATION (QUESTIONS 1–7)

- **0–7** Mild symptoms
- **8–19** Moderate symptoms
- **20–35** Severe symptoms

SA STG

- BPH: obstructive (weak, intermittent stream, hesitancy) and irritative (frequency, nocturia, urgency) symptoms ✚
- Palpate for a distended bladder — retention may occur without severe symptoms ✚
- Refer all patients with suspected BPH ✚
- Hard, nodular prostate on DRE → suspect cancer → refer ✚

PEARLS

- Self-completed by the patient; use to track response to treatment
- Score is symptom severity only — always check for retention, haematuria, UTI and renal function

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